Mitsue Project — Master To-Do List

Status options: Not started · In progress · Blocked · Done · Ongoing | Sorted by phase | Print on A3 (front)

Phase	Task	Owner	Status	Due	Priority	Notes
Phase 0	**Private meeting with Mitsue village mayor**	Rob + JP co-founder	Not started		High	*Listen first, present second*
	Meet 自治会 leaders in Sugano + surrounding hamlets	JP co-founder	Not started		High	
	Identify and confirm Japanese co-founder	Rob	In progress		Critical	*Most important single decision*
	Identify 3–5 founding team members	Rob	Not started		High	*Verbal commitments OK*
	Quiet conversations with 2–3 sympathetic landowners	JP co-founder	Not started		Medium	*Gauge sugi harvesting interest*
	Draft 2-page preliminary charter (JP + EN)	Rob	Not started		High	
	Confirm advisory commitments (Joi Ito, Ray Ozzie) in writing	Rob	Not started		High	*Even informal email*
	Confirm support letter intent — Sandra Pellegrom / Dutch Consulate	Rob	In progress		High	
	Reach out to 1–2 candidate 行政書士 in Nara	Rob	Not started		Medium	*For permits + grant apps*
	Open project Slack/Signal/email list	Rob	Not started		Low	
Phase 1	**Draft 定款 (articles of incorporation)**	行政書士	Not started		High	
	Notarize 定款	行政書士	Not started		High	*~¥50,000*
	Register 一般社団法人 with Legal Affairs Bureau	行政書士	Not started		Critical	*~¥110,000 registration tax*
	Tax registration (法人税, 消費税)	税理士	Not started		High	
	Open corporate bank account	Representative Director	Not started		High	
	Set up accounting system (e.g. 弥生会計)	税理士	Not started		Medium	
	Commission Forestry Feasibility Study	Tech Director	Not started		Critical	*¥1.5–3M, 林野庁-aligned consultant*
	Commission Energy Systems Feasibility Study	Tech Director	Not started		Critical	*¥2–4M*
	Commission Building & Site Assessment	Tech Director	Not started		Critical	*¥1–2M, school structural check*
	Commission Connectivity Assessment	Tech Director	Not started		High	*¥0.3–0.5M, NTT coordination*
	Secure letter of interest from Mitsue village government	Representative Director	Not started		High	
	Launch bilingual project website (basic, professional)	Rob	Not started		Medium	
	Formalize advisory board	Rob	Not started		Medium	
Phase 2	**Detailed engineering & architectural plans**	Tech Director + vendor	Not started		Critical	
	File 伐採届出 (cutting notification)	行政書士	Not started		High	*Forest Act*
	Building conversion permits (建築基準法)	行政書士	Not started		High	
	消防 approvals for biomass plant	行政書士	Not started		High	
	電気事業法 compliance for power generation	行政書士	Not started		High	
	FIT/FIP registration with METI	行政書士	Not started		High	
	Landowner partnership template contract	弁護士	Not started		High	
	Vendor selection — biomass equipment	Tech Director	Not started		High	
	Vendor selection — data center hardware	Tech Director	Not started		High	
	Submit 地方創生 grant application	行政書士 + Rep Dir	Not started		Critical	*Cabinet Office*
	Submit 林野庁 forestry subsidy application	行政書士	Not started		Critical	
	Submit NEDO grant application	行政書士	Not started		High	
	Submit METI green tech subsidy application	行政書士	Not started		High	
	Submit Nippon Foundation grant application	Rob	Not started		High	
	Submit Japan Fund for Global Environment application	Rob	Not started		High	
	Initial outreach — Dutch corporates (Philips, ASML, RHDHV, Arcadis)	Rob	Not started		Medium	*CSR / sustainability framing*
	Initial outreach — JP corporates (NTT, SoftBank, Sumitomo Forestry)	JP co-founder	Not started		Medium	
	Hire first 2–3 part-time staff	Operations Director	Not started		Medium	
Phase 3	**Harvest first 5–10 ha of sugi**	Forestry Director	Not started		Critical	
	Replant native species on harvested plots	Forestry Director	Not started		Critical	
	Install small biomass boiler + heat recovery	Tech Director + vendor	Not started		Critical	*Thermal first, not electrical*
	Renovate one wing of school for office + small server room	Tech Director	Not started		Critical	
	Install ~10–20 servers (edge compute)	Tech Director	Not started		High	
	Install 2–4 EV charging stations	Tech Director	Not started		Medium	*Visible village benefit*
	Apply for J-Credit certification	Forestry Director	Not started		Medium	*Carbon credits*
Phase 4	**Begin convert to NPO法人 (18–24 months in)**	Representative Director	Not started		High	*Long-term legitimacy*
	Establish ongoing operations team	Operations Director	Not started		High	
	Publish open data + open methodology	Rob	Not started		Medium	*Funder commitment*
	Plan replication in 1–2 other villages	Rep Dir + Rob	Not started		Medium	
Cross-cutting	**Diversify funding — never depend on one source**	Rob	Ongoing		Critical	*Risk mitigation*
	Document succession plan (reduce Rob-dependency)	Rep Dir	Not started		High	
	Quarterly board reviews	Rep Dir	Ongoing		Medium	
	Annual financial reporting	税理士	Ongoing		High	

Phase 0 · Phase 1 · Phase 2 · Phase 3 · Phase 4 · Cross-cutting · **Critical** · **High** · Medium · Low

Mitsue Project — Legal Checklist & Risk Register

Companion to Master To-Do | Print on A3 (back)

Legal & Regulatory Checklist

Category	Item	Done?	Notes
Entity & Tax	一般社団法人 incorporation	☐	
	Tax registration (法人税, 消費税)	☐	
	Bank account opening	☐	
	Accounting system (e.g. 弥生会計)	☐	
	Annual financial reporting	☐	
Permits	Forestry permit — 伐採届出 (Forest Act)	☐	
	Land use coordination — 農業委員会 if agricultural land	☐	
	Building conversion — 建築基準法	☐	
	Fire & safety — 消防 approvals for biomass	☐	
	Electrical — 電気事業法 compliance	☐	
	FIT/FIP registration — METI	☐	
	Environmental impact — 環境アセスメント (if scale triggers)	☐	
	Data center compliance — APPI + cybersecurity	☐	
Pro support	Engage 行政書士 (Nara-based ideal)	☐	
	Engage 公認会計士 / 税理士	☐	
	弁護士 consult — landowner contracts	☐	
	Patent attorney — only if novel IP arises	☐	

Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Owner
Local community resistance	Medium	High	*Phase 0 trust-building before any announcements*	Rep Dir
Forestry economics worse than expected	High	High	*Independent feasibility study early; alt. biomass sources ready*	Forestry Dir
Funding gaps between phases	Medium	High	*Diversified funding; never depend on one source; conservative phase budgets*	Rob
Founder dependency on Rob	Medium	High	*Strong co-founders, documented processes, succession plan*	Rep Dir
Building unsuitable for data center	Low	High	*Early structural assessment in Phase 1*	Tech Dir
Fiber connectivity insufficient	Medium	Medium	*Early NTT consultation; satellite/microwave backup*	Tech Dir
Regulatory delays	High	Medium	*Start permits early; build buffer into timeline*	行政書士
Team conflict / mission drift	Medium	High	*Clear charter, regular reviews, term limits*	Rep Dir

Derived from `mitsue_todo.xlsx` — May 2026